

Document 28. CSQ Question-Type Drill Sets

Grouped CSQ practice questions by command word. Each set contains a model approach and 4–6 practice questions. Pair with the Command Word Grid (Doc 2) and Evaluation Toolkit (Doc 24).

Section A. Drill Set 1 — “Describe” and “Identify” (1–3 marks each)

Model approach: state trend (rise / fall / fluctuate) + magnitude + time period + turning points. No explanation required.

1. Identify two components of Singapore’s Current Account from Extract X.
2. Describe the trend in core inflation between 2020 and 2024.
3. Identify the years in which MAS tightened the S\$NEER policy band.
4. Describe the change in real GDP growth rate over the period.
5. Identify two trade partners of Singapore from Table 1.

Section B. Drill Set 2 — “Account for” (3–6 marks each)

Model approach: for each reason: claim → mechanism → data citation.

1. Account for the rise in Singapore’s inflation rate in 2022.
2. Account for the persistent current account surplus in Singapore.
3. Account for the slow growth in real wages between 2015 and 2020.
4. Account for the rise in COE premiums.
5. Account for the divergence between resident and overall unemployment rates.

Section C. Drill Set 3 — “Explain” (3–6 marks each)

Model approach: definition → mechanism → diagram (if applicable) → outcome statement.

1. Explain how an appreciation of the S\$NEER affects domestic inflation.
2. Explain why the government may impose a tax on sugary drinks.
3. Explain how COE quotas affect the price of new cars.
4. Explain how a fall in foreign income affects Singapore’s export earnings.
5. Explain how the multiplier process amplifies a rise in government expenditure.

Section D. Drill Set 4 — “Analyse” (6–10 marks each)

Model approach: define → diagram → step-by-step analysis → link to the question context.

1. Analyse the impact of a rise in oil prices on the Singapore economy.
2. Analyse the effect of MAS tightening on the Singapore economy.

3. Analyse the impact of US-China trade tensions on Singapore's BOT.
4. Analyse the impact of a carbon tax on the Singapore manufacturing sector.
5. Analyse the effect of the GST hike from 7% to 9% on consumer welfare.

Section E. Drill Set 5 — “Discuss” and “Evaluate” (8–15 marks each)

Model approach: two-sided body → stance → weighted evaluation → context-aware conclusion. Apply the C-E-F test.

1. Discuss whether MAS should continue to tighten policy in 2024.
2. Evaluate the effectiveness of the Jobs Growth Incentive in addressing cyclical unemployment.
3. Evaluate the use of fiscal policy to address inequality in Singapore.
4. Discuss whether the carbon tax is the most appropriate policy to address climate change in Singapore.
5. Evaluate whether free trade has been beneficial for Singapore's standard of living.
6. Discuss whether the Singapore government should prioritise growth over equity.

Section F. Drill Set 6 — “Suggest / Recommend” (4–10 marks each)

Model approach: identify the problem → pick the policy with best fit → explain transmission → flag one limitation.

1. Suggest a policy to address structural unemployment among older workers.
2. Recommend a policy to reduce Singapore's reliance on imported food.
3. Suggest a policy to address the rising cost of healthcare.
4. Recommend a policy to encourage greater female labour force participation.
5. Suggest a policy to improve productivity in the services sector.

Section G. Self-Marking Rubric

Level 1	(50–60%)	Identification + brief explanation; minimal diagram; no evaluation.
Level 2	(60–70%)	Clear analysis with diagram and data; one-sided treatment for evaluative parts.
Level 3	(70%+)	Two-sided analysis with diagram, data, and substantive evaluation; reasoned judgement linked to context.